

PROJECTORS

Projectors have become more multi-purpose and even more affordable. No longer are they considered to be the sole domain of the business sphere that needs a large display for presentations, training programmes and such. We're looking at sub-Rs 50,000 projectors making a splash in India and these are aimed at those wanting a home cinema system. Obviously if you want greater quality you pay for it and while a projector costing Rs 1 lakh will outperform a Rs. 50,000 projector the fact that you can buy a projector and screen for under Rs 50,000 today itself is good news. The high-end projectors have also become a lot more affordable meaning you will pay around Rs 1 lakh for a projector that was priced at around the Rs 1.5 lakh region.

Projectors Up To Rs 50,000

REIGNING CHAMPION

Epson EMP S5

This projector was exceptional under the price of Rs 50,000. In fact with current price revisions it manages to crack the sub-Rs 40,000 price barrier and delivers good performance to boot. We found this projector to produce good, clear text and decent colours; which makes it suitable for small business houses who want something compact that performs well. Its very sturdily built too; the only possible shortcoming we could think of is the very boxy shape, which will not appeal to most.

CHALLENGER(S)

None

AND THE WINNER IS

Epson EMP S5



Epson has a winner on its hands. Even though Sharp's XR-30X was slightly better a performer, one cannot deny the Rs 9,000 price difference between the two which pushes things strongly in favour of Epson. If you're looking for a projector than exemplifies bang for buck; this is it.



BEST PERFORMER

NEC NP 4000

The NP 4000 is the biggest projector we've ever had in our labs. With an XGA resolution that should be good enough for most users this projector boasts of a real contrast ratio of 2100:1 which is nothing short of superb. The brightness is a dazzling 5200 lumens. It performs flawlessly in DisplayMate, and is very suitable for any kind of text or presentation usage. Multimedia users and gamers will also like the good contrast ratio. Priced at an astronomical Rs. 3,65,000 the NP 4000 demolishes anything we've ever tested.



Rs 50,000 To Rs 1 Lakh

REIGNING CHAMPION

Sony VPL-EX 5

This projector impressed us with its superb build quality and pristine piano white finish. The body shape is equally attractive and this projector will draw looks from just about anyone. Its very good at producing text, and photos look amazing with Sony's slight tendency to produce rich, vibrant colours. This projector is good for watching movies and playing games; it handles both applications with equal ease.

CHALLENGER(S)

None

AND THE WINNER IS

Sony VPL-EX 5

Sony wins, hands down in this price category. We could not find a better projector for this price point. For its style, looks, features and performance you will not be disappointed for odd the Rs 60,000 that you spend on it; and it outperforms many projectors that cost 25 per cent more.